



Increasing Time Spent Listening on Spotify India

Market Landscape, User Research & Product Outcomes

Milestone 1 | Spotify India Product Case

August 2026

India's music streaming market is large and growing, with strong competition for listeners

MARKET SIZE & GROWTH

- ~178M people streamed music online in India in 2025.
- Paid music subscriptions reached ~14.4M, up 37% YoY.
- Music streaming usage grew further in 2025.

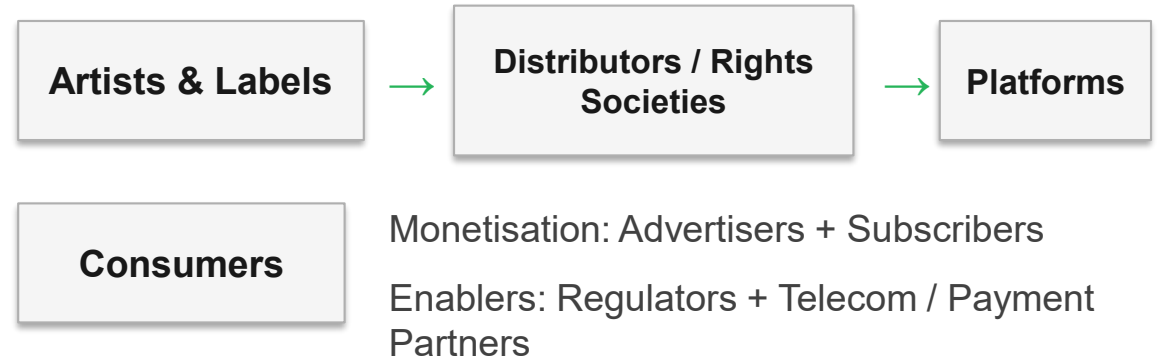
COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

- Key players: Spotify, YouTube Music, JioSaavn, Gaana, Apple Music and Amazon Music.
- YouTube Music: video + discovery ecosystem.
- JioSaavn / Gaana: Indian, Bollywood and regional focus.
- Apple Music: premium audio; Spotify: personalisation and discovery.

REGULATORY & LICENSING

- Copyright & licensing: no statutory licence for on-demand streaming → rights issues can affect catalogue availability.
- Data protection (DPDP): rules govern use of personal data → may affect personalisation.
- IT / OTT rules: online content requirements can affect availability of some content.

ECOSYSTEM ACTORS



Market takeaway: a large listener base, many competing platforms and a mostly free market shape the opportunity.

Discovery, continuity and ease of use are key ways platforms compete for listening

COMPETITOR RESEARCH

- YouTube Music: video-led discovery and the wider YouTube ecosystem.
- JioSaavn / Gaana: strong Indian, Bollywood and regional-language positioning.
- Apple Music: Lossless and Spatial Audio.
- Spotify: strong personalisation, discovery and social listening.

SPOTIFY EXPERIENCE

- Discovery: Discover Weekly, Release Radar and Daylist help users find something to play.
- Continuity: Autoplay, Smart Shuffle and queue recommendations help sessions continue.
- Social: Jam and Collaborative Playlists can extend shared listening.

USER / SECONDARY RESEARCH

- Free-tier friction: ads, skip limits and playback restrictions are recurring complaints.
- Playback or recommendations that do not match user intent can create frustration.
- Spotify says podcasts can add more days of engagement.

WHAT THIS SUGGESTS

Help users find relevant content

Keep a listening session going

Create more reasons to return / listen

Higher-quality listening strengthens engagement, retention and business value

WHY DOES TIME SPENT LISTENING MATTER?

- Engagement: Spotify reported 10% growth in streaming hours per subscriber from 2021–2025.
- Retention: Spotify links stronger engagement and more listening days with sustained user/subscriber growth and low churn.
- Business value: ad-supported listening creates more opportunities to serve ads; stronger engagement also supports Premium retention and conversion.
- More listening occasions: Spotify says podcasts can add more days of engagement.

More valuable listening → stronger engagement → better retention and business value

Spotify also evaluates engagement through listening days and return frequency; device usage is a broader engagement signal.

Important: more listening does not automatically equal more revenue; ad load, fill, pricing and Premium conversion also matter.

Among existing listeners, Time Spent Listening can increase through more listening days, more sessions per day or longer sessions

Business outcome

$$\text{REVENUE} = \text{PREMIUM + AD-SUPPORTED}$$

Target segment

$$\text{FREE USERS} \times \text{LOW-TO-MID LISTENING FREQUENCY}$$

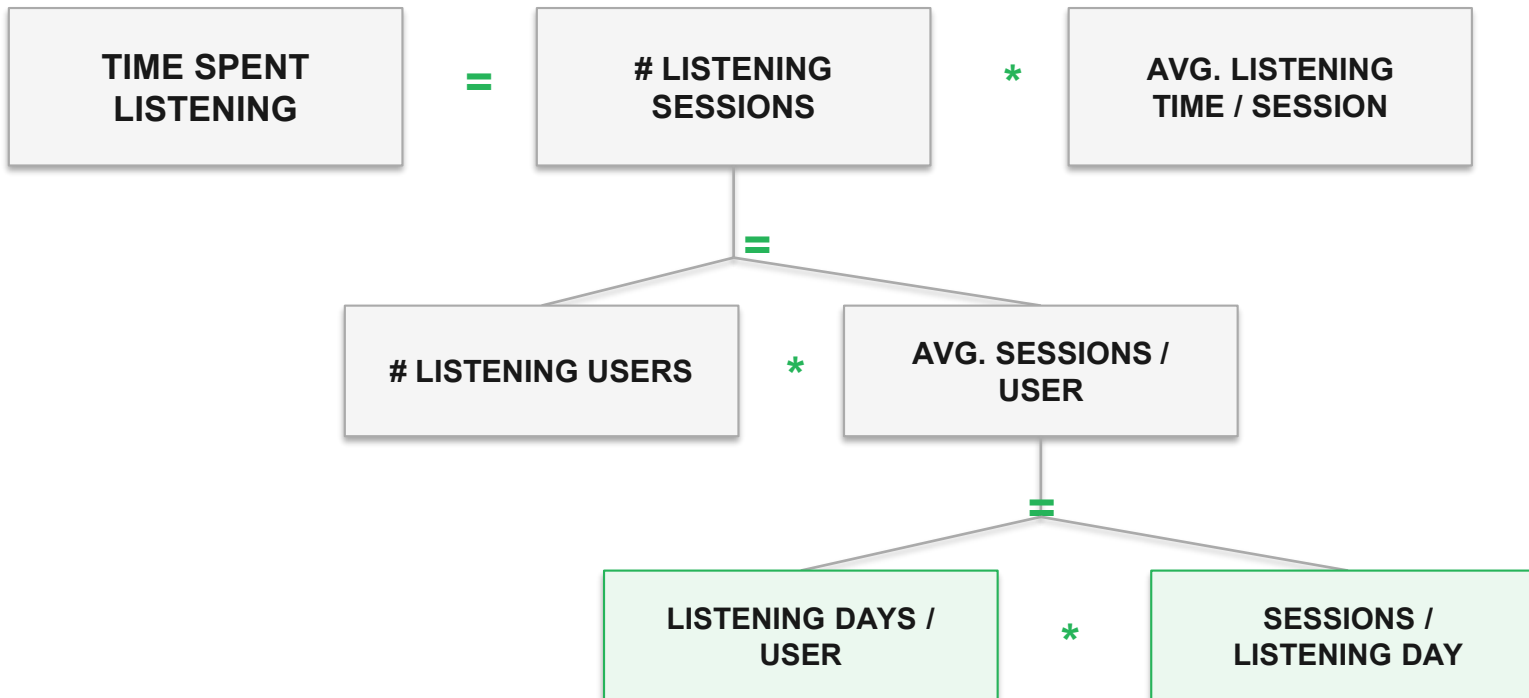
Segmentation lens: User Behaviour → Frequency + Monetisation

Potential product outcomes

$$\text{INCREASE LISTENING DAYS / USER}$$

$$\text{Increase sessions / listening day}$$

$$\text{Increase avg. listening time / session}$$



TIME SPENT LISTENING = # Listening Users * Listening Days/User * Sessions/Listening Day * Avg. Listening Time/Session